



(From left) Kanimozhi, Zinta, Pilot, Akula and Malik

HEMANT CHAWLA

"Believe in your principles"

SACHIN PILOT CONGRESS MP

To change the world is such a grand thing to be able to do. But we need to eradicate starvation and malnutrition in the world, to put every child in the school across the globe, every single person should have access to sanitation and clean drinking water to effectively reverse malaria and typhoid.

I have one suggestion. There are a number of elections in the country—municipal, zila parishad, assembly or general elections. My suggestion is to have all of them at one time. This will save time, energy, money, resource, and people can then save the rest four-and-half-years to things that are more important. I am now digressing. Also, one of the biggest crisis we will face is of potable, clean, safe drinking water. In my constituency in Rajasthan, one has to dig up to 800 ft to get drinking water. Broadband connectivity and wi-fi can wait but for a woman who carries two children on her head for two miles to get drinking water, we have to legislate and make it a fundamental right in this country that every one must have access to at least clean drinking water.

I also think about the physically challenged. I think we have to legislate sooner than later that all trains, planes, automobiles, government offices and other buildings must be made accessible to the physically challenged people.

This is a tough one, but I think if we could segregate religion from politics, it will serve the country a great deal. I think religion is a matter of personal choice and should be confined to our home and hearts. We have to begin a paradigm change in the system. To live and believe, in our principles, in our convictions so that we can end up changing the world, and not let the world end up changing us.

"Change the world's greed"

PREITY ZINTA ACTOR

Well I will start with a quote from Mahatma Gandhi. He said, "The earth provides enough to satisfy every man's need but not for every man's greed". If I could change the world, I would like to change the greed, which we all have in us, even though it sounds really philosophical. If there was no greed in man there would be no objection to having a little girl as a child—the greed of giving dowry and the greed of getting it. I would also like every man to live in a woman's body for not a month, not a year, just for a day, so that more respect would be given to women in this country. India is the only country in the world where we have a term called eve-teasing. I would like to talk about corruption. The way we are going forward, we are also going backward.

Another point, I would like to say is that, this forum is about "If I could change the world" and my question to everybody is—haven't we already changed the world? How much more do we want to change in this world? Look at the floods in Mumbai, snow in Dubai—how much more, physically, are we going to change this world? I know we have technology and a lot of other things that are taking us forward to enhance our lifespans. There is medicine but are we not reducing the life of this planet? So I would like to see a greener planet, something to do with global warming. I am not going to speak for too long. I would like to say that as I stand here today, in this Conclave, I am very very proud of being an Indian. And for me, India starts with Kashmir and ends at Kanyakumari. And we are proud of every Indian in this country and we have always stood by each other.